Good Cop, Bad Cop

Actor Vijay Varma breaks new ground in his role as a vigilante cop in *Kaalkoot*, streaming on JioCinema

Q. Finally, a role without greys. How did that feel?

Actually, I do not approach roles with the idea of whether they are black, white or grey. It should excite me and make me feel like I may not be able to pull it off. I know it's strange, but it should be a challenge. The quirkier the character, the better. Ravi Shankar Tripathi in *Kaalkoot* is just that. As the trailer suggests, he is a man of the system, who goes against the system and becomes a bridge that leads to a resolution. I found that trajectory very interesting.

Q. But you have mostly played negative characters. How did you get pigeonholed?

As an acting student in FTII and also during my theatre days, I figured out that the layering was much more complex in some characters. It wasn't about good or bad, but more about how much a character contributed to the growth of the narrative. I am so grateful I could do the kind of roles I have done in the past. For me, the order of preference for choosing a project is first the script, then the role, and then the director. I am now getting a wide variety of roles that excite me...some romantic ones too.

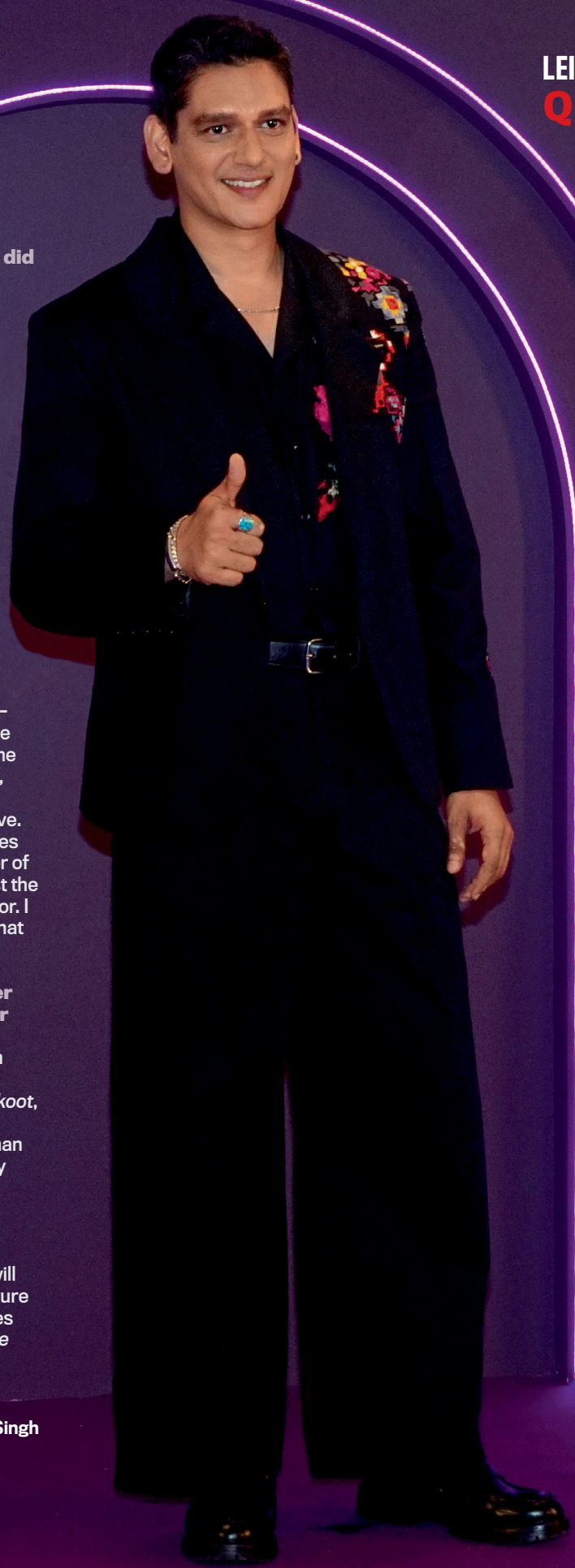
Q. So is there anyone whose career trajectory you follow, or admire, or consider modelling yours on?

All the icons I admire have had their own journey. From Irrfan, to Tabu, to even Eminem, I look up to everyone. For *Kaalkoot*, I did draw a lot of inspiration from Mr Amitabh Bachchan. That angry young man persona was definitely at the back of my mind. But it has a lot of me too.

Q. What other projects are you looking forward to?

Well, for now, *Mirzapur*'s third season will be there. *Murder Mubarak* is also signature Homi Adajania and rather quirky. Besides these, Sujoy Ghosh is all set to adapt *The Devotion of Suspect X*. These are some projects that are keeping me revved up.

with Aarti Kapur Singh



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